

Gareth Thomas

Consultant, technologist, and founder based in Eindhoven, Netherlands

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At a glance

Role	Consultant, CGI Nederland
Location	Nuenen, Netherlands
Focus	Consulting • Founder • Community
Languages	English, Portuguese, Italian, Dutch

By the numbers

20+	1	6+	4
Years in engineering, consulting & entrepreneurship	Company founded — VersionBay	Years chairing PyData Eindhoven	Languages spoken

About

I'm a consultant and founder with a control-theory engineering foundation. After nearly a decade at MathWorks — from application engineer to Business Development Manager for global Academic strategy — I co-founded VersionBay, running it alongside a stint as Country Manager Benelux at Open iT and the MATLAB Coders hobby project. Today I work as a Consultant at CGI Nederland after a year directing consulting services, having previously led delivery, sales enablement, and technical strategy across the US, Portugal, and the Netherlands. Alongside client work, I chair PyData Eindhoven's organizing committee and co-host the Inspiring Computing podcast — both going on their sixth and fourth year respectively.

Raised in an actuarial family, and now married with two kids. I try to live my motto, not just say it: I build my own apps (Meetello, Brainport AI's Game Hub), lean on AI daily to accelerate my work, and even used it to build this very CV site.

Experience

Twenty years spanning engineering, technical sales, entrepreneurship, and consulting — with three companies built or led as country manager along the way.



CGI Nederland

Consultant · Jan 2026 – Present · Eindhoven Area, Netherlands

Supporting delivery and consulting work in the Eindhoven area.

- **ProRail** — Front-end Tester and Architect for railmaps.nl.

Director Consulting Services · Mar 2025 – Feb 2026 · 1 yr · Eindhoven Area, Netherlands

Directed consulting delivery and service growth on rejoining CGI, ahead of moving into a hands-on Consultant role. Managed a team of 17 people across the Eindhoven region, against a sales target of over €4M.

- **ASML** — Worked as Senior Consultant, leading the migration from Subversion to Git for hundreds of developers.

cgi.com/nl/en

Entrepreneurial ventures

Nov 2018 – Mar 2025 · 6 yrs 5 mo · Eindhoven Area, Netherlands

Ran two ventures at once between 2019 and 2021 — VersionBay and Open iT's Benelux territory — alongside the MATLAB Coders hobby project.



VersionBay — Co-Founder



Open iT, Inc. — Country Manager Benelux

Nov 2018 – Mar 2025 · 6 yrs 5 mo

Co-founded and ran the company for six and a half years, empowering people to leverage state-of-the-art software stacks.

Client assignments:

- **ASML** — Regression testing.
- **DNB** (De Nederlandsche Bank) — Financial modeling and application deployment.
- **ESA** (European Space Agency) — Updating Simulink models to newer versions.

Also built VersionBay's own training content and products: **Toolbox Usage Analyzer**, for measuring MATLAB usage, and **Package Tester**, which automatically generates regression tests while migrating from older MATLAB versions to newer ones — with automatic pipeline generation to pinpoint effort and where new MATLAB/Simulink versions caused migration work.

versionbay.com

Jan 2020 – Sep 2021 · 1 yr 9 mo

Ran the Benelux territory for Open iT, giving companies visibility into actual usage of their engineering software assets.



MathWorks

Jan 2009 – Sep 2018 · 9 yrs 9 mo

Business Development Manager

Industry Manager – Education

Senior Application Engineer

Application Engineer

Jan 2017 – Sep 2018 · 1 yr 9 mo · Eindhoven Area, Netherlands

Led definition and execution of MathWorks' global Academic strategy, partnering with universities worldwide to grow MATLAB and Simulink adoption in teaching, learning, and research — capping 8+ years at the company that started as an application engineer in embedded code generation.

Collaborated with Arduino to drive the Engineering Kit that Arduino used to offer, and helped create the MathWorks Academia keynote — delivered alongside the main company keynote — two years running.

Jan 2014 – Jan 2017 · 3 yrs 1 mo

Guided business planning, marketing, and sales strategy for the global Education market, directing sales/services teams and driving awareness of MathWorks technology across academic institutions worldwide.

May 2012 – Dec 2013 · 1 yr 8 mo

Acted as technical lead and customer advocate on key accounts, running public and private technical events, supporting complex sales evaluations, and feeding customer insight back into product development.

Jan 2009 – Apr 2012 · 3 yrs 4 mo

Demonstrated MathWorks tools through hands-on customer engagements centred on rapid prototyping, automatic code generation, and code verification/validation, including deploying MATLAB into .NET and Java environments.

Also helped drive, organize, and moderate the MathWorks Research Summit for three years.

A strong believer in and promoter of MathWorks' support for RoboCup — volunteering at the University-level competition in 2001, then driving MathWorks' backing of RoboCup over the following years.

Visited and worked with several companies and institutions across the MathWorks years, giving presentations and demos and helping teams put MATLAB and Simulink to work: ESA, CNH, ASML, VDL, Punch, TU/e, and TU Delft. Also worked with KROHNE in the Netherlands, visited the LEGO HQ in Denmark, and worked with Lely, Belfius (Belgium), Goodyear (Luxembourg), and Toyota (Luxembourg), among others.

Gave talks at top engineering universities in Israel, Turkey, Greece, Hungary, and South Africa, and visited universities in Japan. Connected with commercial companies in Turkey on Code Generation, Verification & Validation, DO-178B/C, and ISO standards, and how to leverage HIL simulations to achieve certification. Gave guest lectures at TU Eindhoven, TU Delft, and Fontys Eindhoven, and supported MathWorks distributors in driving their regional Education strategy.

Completed several internal MathWorks training courses, including Difficult Conversations, Presentation Skills, Sales Training, and Salesforce training. Also received media training and served as an official spokesperson for MathWorks.

Still an active member of the MATLAB Central community since 2011 — rank 549 of 301,994, 70 Answers contributed, 3 files published, and 2,608 total downloads.

mathworks.com · [MATLAB Central profile](#)

Oceanscan

Software Engineer · Jan 2007 – Dec 2008 · 2 yrs · Scotland

Delivered system integration from sonar GUIs to acoustic signal-processing algorithms, working across mechanical, electrical, and software teams, with systems testing as a core responsibility.

oceanscan.com

Altran CIS

Consultant · Dec 2005 – Dec 2006 · 1 yr 1 mo · Portugal

Contributed to design, implementation, and testing on a large-scale telecom access-network project, including redundancy coding to meet carrier coding standards. Also served as innovation officer, leading a five-person creative team on-site at client Nokia Siemens.

altran.com

Skills

Self-rated on a simple scale, based on demonstrated experience across this CV:

Stars	Meaning
★☆☆☆☆	I can give a 5-minute demo
★★☆☆☆	I can talk for 30 minutes about it
★★★☆☆	I can teach others
★★★★★	I can add truly innovative content, give multi-day workshops, and provide feedback to maintainers, owners, and thought leaders

Technical

Skill	Rating	Evidence
MATLAB	★★★★★	9+ years at MathWorks (Application Engineer → Business Development Manager), a US patent on model configuration equivalence, active MATLAB Central contributor since 2011, maintainer of MATLAB Jokes, and recurring "What's New" release talks since 2019
Simulink	★★★★★	Code generation and Simulink productivity talks (including the MathWorks Racing Lounge session), the same model-configuration patent, and hands-on ESA Simulink upgrade work at VersionBay
Git	★★★★★	Led the Subversion-to-Git migration for hundreds of developers at ASML as Senior Consultant, and built <code>git4MATLABusers</code>
DevOps	★★★★★	Built VersionBay's automatic regression-test generation and pipeline product, and led the ASML Subversion-to-Git migration
CI/CD	★★★★★	"Continuous Integration with MATLAB" talk at MATLAB Coders & Jenkins, and automated MATLAB testing pipelines with GitHub Actions
Azure DevOps	★★★★	Applied within enterprise consulting engagements at CGI
Testing & Test Automation	★★★★★	Built VersionBay's automatic regression-test generation and pipeline product, ran ASML regression testing engagements, and gave the "Top 10 Lessons in Adopting Playwright" talk as CGI/ProRail Tester
Playwright	★★★★	Front-end testing work at CGI/ProRail, plus the "Top 10 Lessons Learnt in Adopting Playwright" talk
Behave	★★★★	BDD testing work at ASML
Kubernetes	★★★★	Applied in delivery work at CGI/ProRail
k6	★★★★	Load testing work at CGI/ProRail
Julia	★★★★	Organizes JuliaLang Eindhoven, gave the "MATLAB → Julia" talk at JuliaCon 2024, and maintains Julia Jokes
Python	★★★★	

Skill	Rating	Evidence
		Chairs PyData Eindhoven, a 1,200+ member data & Python community, for six years running
NumPy	★★	Hosted an in-depth conversation with Ralf Gommers, Director of Quansight Labs, on Inspiring Computing
FastAPI	★★	Used building web tooling for VersionBay and side projects
Embedded Systems & Code Generation (C/C++)	★★★★	Early MathWorks work on rapid prototyping, automatic code generation, and MATLAB deployment into .NET/Java, plus the Hardware-in-the-Loop talk
Rust	★★	Maintains Rust Jokes and co-led the Julia/Rust ecosystem panel at the Julia x Rust Meetup Eindhoven
Claude Code	★★★★	Used extensively to build and maintain this CV site
GitHub Copilot	★★	Part of daily AI-accelerated development workflow
LM Studio	★★	Local LLM tooling for experimentation
Ollama	★★	Local LLM tooling for experimentation
PowerPoint	★★★★	Built and delivered decks across a decade of MathWorks BDM work, CGI consulting, and community talks

Leadership, Communication & Delivery

Skill	Rating	Evidence
Managing People	★★★★★	Managed a team of 17 across the Eindhoven region as Director Consulting Services at CGI
Business Development & Consulting	★★★★★	MathWorks Business Development Manager for global Academic strategy, Director Consulting Services at CGI against a >€4M sales target, and co-founder running VersionBay for six and a half years
Project Management	★★★★★	Ran VersionBay for six and a half years, directed a 17-person consulting practice at CGI, and led the ASML Subversion-to-Git migration across hundreds of developers
Giving Presentations	★★★★★	A full Talks Given history spanning JuliaCon, meetups, and podcasts
Demos	★★★★★	Recurring hands-on "What's New in MATLAB" demos and the MathWorks Racing Lounge session
Coaching Others	★★★	Teaching talks at 040Coders and MATLABers Unite, and managing a 17-person team at CGI
Inspiring People to Give Talks	★★★★★	Recruits and lines up external speakers across six organized communities, and hosts a podcast literally named <i>Inspiring Computing</i>
Organizing Events	★★★★★	Organizes or moderates six technical communities — PyData Eindhoven, AlgoSphere, JuliaLang Eindhoven, Dutch Cloud Native, JAVA Eindhoven, and FOSS4GNL
Triggering Change	★★★★★	Lives the Embracing Change motto — from MathWorks to founder, MATLAB advocate to Julia organizer, and leading the ASML Subversion-to-Git migration

Education



Instituto Superior Técnico

MSc, Control Theory · 2000 – 2005 · Lisbon, Portugal

The top engineering university in Portugal. Completed an MSc with a strong focus on control theory, systems thinking, embedded development, and practical engineering problem-solving.

- Final thesis: obstacle avoidance system for autonomous catamarans, graded 19/20. View final thesis PDF
- Highlighted rapid prototyping on embedded systems for catamaran applications.
- Discovered MATLAB during university and became the go-to MATLAB specialist in the cohort.
- Finished in the top 10% of the degree, with an average of 75% across five years; the cohort started with 250 students and only 30 completed the degree within the expected five-year period.

ist.utl.pt

LinkedIn Learning Certifications

Certification	Completed
Delivering an Authentic Elevator Pitch	Jan 2021
How to Create a Perfect Elevator Pitch	Jan 2021
Effective Listening	Dec 2020
Guy Kawasaki on How to Rock Social Media	Dec 2020
Executive Presence on Video Conference Calls	Nov 2020
Building Tools with Python	Sep 2020
Body Language for Leaders	Apr 2020
Continuous Integration: Tools	Aug 2019
Python: Programming Efficiently	Jun 2019
Unit Testing and Test Driven Development in Python	Jun 2019
Code Clinic: Python	May 2019
Programming Foundations: Refactoring Code	May 2019

Earlier Education

- **Kellett School, Hong Kong** · Ages 6–7
- **Escola Portuguesa de Macau, Macau** · Ages 7–10 — Started speaking only English, in a class split evenly between Cantonese and Portuguese speakers. Three years later, at age 10, was the best student in the country and won a prize for it.
- **Colégio Campo de Flores, Portugal** · Ages 10–15
- **Anselmo de Andrade, Almada, Portugal** · Ages 15–18 — Represented the school in Math Olympiads, progressing all the way to the international level.

What people say

A few LinkedIn recommendations from colleagues and clients over the years:

Gareth is one of those people that can motivate an entire team.

— **Duarte Antunes**, Associate Professor, Eindhoven University of Technology

Working with Gareth at The MathWorks is a real pleasure. He has great enthusiasm and energy for every task and always considered ways to improve how things were done.

— **Marc Wouters**, Sr Sales Account Manager Belux, MathWorks

[He] turns out to be an outstanding public speaker and to have amazing explanation skills. In short, he is an inspirational co-worker who has the perfect combination of skills that make true leaders.

— **Jean-Philippe Villaréal**, Lead Developer, Consafe Logistics Group

Gareth's "Yes we can!" mentality, technical credibility and drive for results sparks to everyone he works with.

— **Caspar Perik**, Director of Business Development, Grace